

Drill Pack

Blind ID Drills · Both Directions · Error Log

Week 8 · Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 · Lecture 8

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How drilling differs from studying: Reading builds understanding. Drilling builds **speed**. You can understand every table in the Study Guide and still blank under time pressure — these drills fix that. Fifteen minutes daily beats two hours on Sunday.

PART A · Blind ID — Voice & Zang-Fu

Heads Up — Cover the right column. Read the description, name the term/organ/pattern out loud, then uncover.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Organ that governs production of the voice	Lung
Organ that governs volume of the voice	Kidney
Organ(s) that govern strength of the voice	Spleen & Stomach
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency
Hoarseness: sudden onset, low pitch, raspy	Exterior syndrome
Hoarseness: chronic, gradual intensity	Blood stagnation
Hoarseness: plum-pit sensation & cough	Phlegm-Heat
Hoarseness: chronic, gradual, worse in evening	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency

PART B · Blind ID — Breathing & Respiration

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Coarse, loud breathing sound	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing sound	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess qi in Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of qi in Liver and Kidney
Respiration: loud sound, rough/distressed breath, acute onset	Excess/Heat
Respiration: low sound, faint/slow breath, slow onset	Empty/Cold
Panting, excess type	Chest full, loud/rough sound — xie qi obstructing Lung
Panting, deficiency type	Timid breath, low voice, worse with movement — Kidney or Lung deficiency
Asthma	Lung qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung qi fails to descend with phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung qi rises upward to throat, obstructs air tract

Shortness of Breath	Lung qi deficiency, or Water Retention in Chest
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PART C · Blind ID — Cough, Sneeze & Reflexive Sounds

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Cough with sound but no phlegm	"Unproductive cough"
Sneezing: acute onset, constant loud sounds	Heat and/or excess
Sneezing: chronic, frequent, soft in volume	Lung deficiency
Sudden sneezing in critical stage of chronic illness	Yang qi recovery
Shared mechanism of vomiting, belching, and hiccup	Rebellious Stomach Qi
Vomiting: slow onset, low/faint/no-force retching sound	ST deficiency and Cold
Vomiting: sudden onset, loud/forceful retching sound	ST-Heat
Belching: loud and long sound	Full (food retention, ST-Heat, or LV-Qi invading ST)
Belching: short and low sound	ST-Qi deficiency (with or without Cold)
Hiccup: loud sound	Full — often LV-Qi invading Stomach
Hiccup: quiet, low sound	Empty — often ST-Qi or ST-Yin deficiency
Borborygmi: loud sound	Full pattern (with diarrhea/dysentery)
Borborygmi: low sound	Empty pattern (SP/KI yang def., MB qi def.)
Yawning: frequent, loud, relieved after, emotion-induced	Liver Qi Stagnation
Yawning: infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency
Sighing from repressed anger/frustration	Liver Qi stagnation
Sighing from worry & sadness	Lung Qi stagnation

PART D · Blind ID — Five Element Sounds & Six Healing Sounds

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Shouting voice — element	Wood Hū 呼
Laughing voice — element	Fire Xiào 笑
Singing voice — element	Earth Chàng 唱
Weeping voice — element	Metal
Groaning voice — element	Water

Xū 嘘 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Liver — removes heat, brightens eyes
Hē 呵 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Heart — expels heat, reduces fire
Hū 呼 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Spleen — drives out heat, strengthens spleen
Sì 呬 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Lung — calms qi, moistens lungs
Chuī 吹 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Kidney — removes wind-cold, urges stagnant qi
Xī 嘻 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Triple Burner — clears heat/restlessness, emotions
Which hanzi/pinyin is shared between a Voice Sound and a Healing Sound?	Hū 呼 — Shout (Wood voice) AND Spleen Healing Sound

PART E · Blind ID — Smelling Framework & the Five Odors

Description (cover the right)	Answer
First aspect of Diagnosis by Smelling	Odor of the patient's body itself — pattern AND constitutional type
Second aspect of Diagnosis by Smelling	Odor of bodily secretions — nature of pattern only
General rule: strong/foul/rotten smell	Heat or Excess
General rule: absent or fishy smell	Cold or Deficient
Goatish body odor	Wind, damp, heat accumulation
Foul, stinking body odor	Epidemic infectious disease, or summer heat toxin
Rancid odor (Sōu 餿) — description	Fat no longer fresh, newly-mown grass, unpleasant
"Fragrant" odor (Xiāng 香) — description	Cloying, sickly sweet, lingers in nostrils — NOT actually pleasant
Rotten odor (Làn 爛) — description	Rotting meat / garbage truck (many substances decomposing)
Putrid odor (Fǔ 腐) — description	Rotting meat / stagnant pond water / stale urine
"Scorched" odor slide's labeled hanzi (and the likely error)	Xiào 笑 (reused from Laughing) — classical scorched is Jiāo 焦

PART F · Blind ID — Odor of Bodily Secretions

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Breath: strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Breath: sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Breath: foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Breath: rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Breath: fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung
Sweat: strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sweat: putrid-smelling	Disease of Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
Sputum: strong/rotten-smelling	Heat in Lungs — Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat

Sputum: fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Sputum: without smell	Cold
Stool: extremely stinky, diarrhea with pus/blood	Damp-Heat in Intestines
Stool/gas: sour and foul with indigestion	Food stagnation
Stool: fishy odor with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Flatulence: slight/odorless, aggravated by emotional stress	Liver qi stagnation
Flatulence: rancid, like rotten eggs	Toxic Heat in Large Intestines
Urine: frequent/urgent/painful/burning, turbid yellow, foul	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Urine: heavy urea smell, scanty yellow	Heart fire pouring into Bladder
Urine: clear, frequent, odorless/slightly fishy	Kidney deficiency
Odorless urinary incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney fire
Vaginal discharge: strong-smelling, leathery	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge: fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Ears: foul, fishy, turbid pus/discharge	Damp-heat in the ear
Eyes: red/swollen, turbid tears, foul fishy odor	Damp-heat in the Liver channel

PART G · Reverse Direction — Pattern → Finding

Heads Up — Now cover the LEFT column instead. Read the pattern, recall the hearing/smelling finding that points to it.

Finding (cover the left)	Pattern (read this side)
Loud voice, excessive talking	Full or Heat
Weak voice, reluctance to talk	Empty or Cold, or Lung-Qi deficiency
Hoarse, worse in the evening, chronic	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency
Coarse loud breathing	Full pattern
Panting worse with movement, timid breath	Kidney deficiency (can't absorb qi) or Lung deficiency (can't govern qi)
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Loud vomiting/belching/hiccup	Excess/Heat, or LV-Qi invading Stomach
Frequent loud yawning relieved by yawning, emotion-triggered	Liver Qi Stagnation
Shouting	Wood
Groaning	Water
Foul, strong, rotten smell (general rule)	Heat or Excess
Fishy or absent smell (general rule)	Cold or Deficient
Strong-smelling sweat	Damp-Heat
Putrid-smelling sweat	Disease of Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
Clear, frequent, odorless urine	Kidney deficiency
Fishy vaginal discharge	Damp-Cold

Error Log

Heads Up — Every time you miss a drill item, log it here. Review this page before your next drill session — your errors are more valuable than your correct answers.

Item I Missed	Correct Answer / Why I Missed It